

Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust ★★

HIGHEST RISK

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 3
OBJECTIVE	Students clearly distinguish between forgiveness (internal, releases resentment) and trust (earned, relational) — and understand they can forgive without reconciling.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation and boundary-setting · Relationship Skills: distinguishing healthy from unsafe relationships
VOCABULARY	forgiveness, trust, reconciliation, boundary, safety, internal
MATERIALS	WS6 Two Separate Decisions · Two-column anchor chart · Scenario cards · Journals · Reflection Pass pre-positioned

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor confirmed ON-SITE or immediately available — full lesson. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Lesson NOT scheduled with a substitute. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned. · 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline posted. · Crisis Text Line (HOME to 741741) posted. · AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines reviewed. MOST LIKELY LESSON TO SURFACE DISCLOSURES ABOUT ONGOING UNSAFE RELATIONSHIPS. Before this lesson: teacher and counselor identify 1–2 students they are watching. Deliver the safety statement BEFORE any content.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Today we go one step further. Has anyone ever been told they had to forgive someone AND be friends with them again — when they did not feel safe?" Today we separate forgiveness and trust.

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Safety Statement — Deliver First

2–5 MIN

Say directly and calmly: "Before we start: in this curriculum, forgiveness is never required when someone is still hurting you. If anything we talk about today makes you think of a situation where you are still being harmed, you can use your Reflection Pass. Your safety is more important than any lesson." Pause. Then proceed.

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS VS. TRUST — TWO SEPARATE DECISIONS (WS6)

Build WITH students through co-construction — do not present it pre-made. Color-code. This chart is the lesson. Keep it posted for the rest of Unit 3.